

STAGE TEN • RELATIONSHIPS & CONNECTIONS

FIRSTS

FAQ

Anticipated participant questions and suggested facilitator responses

A Citrus Edition Facilitator Resource • Companion to the FIRSTS Manual

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PURPOSE

These are the questions that come up most often across cohorts of Stage Ten, with a suggested facilitator response for each. Use these as a starting point, not a rigid script.

Frequently Asked Questions

Q1. What if I genuinely don't have a close friendship to reference for this stage?

A: That's useful information, not a failure. Shift the focus to a newer or less-deep connection you'd like to genuinely invest in — the exercises work the same way, just applied earlier in a relationship's life.

Q2. Do I have to share personal details about a friendship or conflict with the group?

A: No. Several exercises ask you to reflect on or act on something specific and personal, but you're never required to disclose details to the group. Facilitators will always tell you clearly when something is opt-in versus a general group activity.

Q3. What if I don't know anyone who could realistically be a mentor?

A: This is genuinely common, especially early in a field. Academic advisors, alumni networks, professional associations, and even instructors you've had a good rapport with are all legitimate starting points — a mentor doesn't need a formal title before the relationship can start developing.

Q4. What if reaching out to a potential mentor feels intimidating?

A: That feeling is normal and doesn't mean you're not ready. A short, specific, low-pressure request (FIRST N22) is far less intimidating to send, and to receive, than people typically expect.

Q5. How do I handle a team conflict that's genuinely still unresolved right now?

A: Use the concepts from FIRST N18 to think through it, but bring the specifics to a private conversation with your facilitator rather than processing an active, real conflict in the group session itself.

Q6. What if a friendship or professional relationship I'm supposed to reflect on has already ended?

A: That's still valid material for reflection — FIRST N30 and several earlier exercises can work with a relationship that changed or ended, examining honestly what happened and what you'd do differently, not just currently active relationships.